6. To discharge such other functions in relation to the protection, welfare and development and advancement of the STs as the President may specify.

OTHER FUNCTIONS

In 2005, the President specified the following other functions of the Commission in relation to the protection, welfare and development and advancement of the STs[5]:

1. Measures to be taken over conferring ownership rights in respect of minor forest produce to STs living in forest areas

2. Measures to be taken to safeguard rights of the tribal communities over mineral resources, water resources etc., as per law

3. Measures to be taken for the development of tribals and to work for more viable livelihood strategies

4. Measures to be taken to improve the efficacy of relief and rehabilitation measures for tribal groups displaced by development projects

5. Measures to be taken to prevent alienation of tribal people from land and to effectively rehabilitate such people in whose case alienation has already taken place

6. Measures to be taken to elicit maximum cooperation and involvement of tribal communities for protecting forests and undertaking social afforestation

7. Measures to be taken to ensure full implementation of the Provisions of Panchayats (Extension to the Scheduled Areas) Act, 1996

8. Measures to be taken to reduce and ultimately eliminate the practice of shifting cultivation by tribals that lead to their continuous disempowerment and degradation of land and the environment

REPORT

The Commission presents an annual report to the President. It can also submit a report as and when it thinks necessary.

The President places all such reports before the Parliament, along with a memorandum explaining the action taken on the recommendations made by the Commission. The memorandum should also contain the reasons for the non-acceptance of any of such recommendations.

The President also forwards any report of the Commission pertaining to a state government to the state governor. The governor places it before the state legislature, along with a memorandum explaining the action taken on the recommendations of the Commission. The memorandum should also contain the reasons for the non-acceptance of any of such recommendations.

POWERS

The Commission is vested with the power to regulate its own procedure.